channels available in the 2.4 Ghz spectrum—1, 6 and 11. If you have a microwave or cordless phone, place them in a position that's well away from your normal work area and access points.

If you find that there are other WLANs using all three channels, increase the transmitting power of your WLAN. Remember to keep access points closer to each other to improve the signal to noise ratio. Also, if too many users log on to your network at the same time, your network performance will degrade—keep access points closer together and reduce the transmission power (the same concept used in your mobile phone). This reduces the number of users per access point.

Obstructions in the WLAN field can also affect performance. Properly survey the area that you want to cover with your WLAN and place access points smartly. Walk about with a laptop and look for coverage holes—spots in your coverage area where network strength drops drastically (even to zero). Shift your access points about and increase transmission strengths to plug these holes. You could also try to get hold of directional antennas, and point them in such a way so as to plug coverage holes.

Sometimes, the access points themselves are to blame, due to lockdowns, broken antennas, use of incorrect power adaptors or varied output frequencies. A reboot of the access point should solve a lockdown problem. Make sure to upgrade the firmware regularly, and also only use adaptors meant for the same model.

Connection Problems: You could face connection problems when moving from one access point's area to another's. This happens when the two access points have different subnet masks.

WLANs that work on the older 802.11a (5 GHz frequency) system are not compatible with newer standards such as 802.11b and g. The newer versions work on the 2.4 GHz frequency and are backward-compatible. You will have to upgrade your network card if you want to connect to an 802.11b/g network.